

Dr Paddy Tobias

[References](#) / [Publications](#) / [GitHub](#) / [Contact](#) / [About](#) / [Resume](#)

About Me

Hi!

I am the data science manager and technical lead at the Social Research Centre. I am passionate about deploying and scaling up data science solutions in a research context.



[Read more about me here...](#)

Current Position

DataOps Manager - The Social Research Centre

2024-present

I lead the SRC's unified Analyst Services and Data Science divisions within the team of Data Operations. Our team covers the full data lifecycle across significant complex, high-stakes research programs. In my role I set technical strategy and drive a multi-year plan to improve the organisation's data capability. This includes initiatives to modernise governance, automate ingestion and curation, and embedding AI/ML accelerators into production workflows. On a more technical level, I also architect scalable, versioned codebases (R / Python / SQL) with CI/CD, dependency management and unit testing to ensure durability, auditability and rapid innovation. A key part of my day-to-day job is to champion data standards, quality control, privacy protection measures and (everyone's favourite!) documentation.

Core focus areas

- **Strategic roadmap:** platform consolidation, building standards, event-driven pipelines, governance KPIs
- **Engineering excellence:** modular package ecosystems, test coverage expansion, automated lineage
- **Operational resilience:** performance observability, secured credential flows
- **Talent development:** capability matrices, technical guilds, paired architecture reviews

Impact highlights

- Reduced end-to-end processing times via orchestration
- Improved data confidence with continuous validation, schema enforcement and drift alerts
- Increased reuse and interoperability through standardised, documented processes

- Accelerated delivery of client insights

Mission: build a future-ready, AI-enabled, standards-driven data capability that all SRC projects can benefit from.

Data Science Manager and Technical Lead - The Social Research Centre

2021-2024

From 2021-2022 I managed a team of eight data scientists and engineers to support the Quality Indicators for Learning and Teaching (QILT) project for the Commonwealth Department of Education. QILT is very complex with a number of parallel end-to-end processes.

In 2022 I became the manager of data science at the SRC, overseeing 18 staff and up to 20 projects at any one time.

In this role I currently drive a development agenda to build efficiencies and scalability in data management and processing for the SRC, including implementing new tools and technologies to improve data quality and readiness.

► **Click** to see a selection of activities

Senior Data Scientist - The Social Research Centre

2019-2021

As senior data scientist, I worked on the Major Projects team for the SRC. The main focus is the [QILT](<https://www.qilt.edu.au/>) project for the Australian Government Department of Education, Skills and Employment.

QILT is a longitudinal study into student experience and outcomes of high education students in Australia, which has been running for over ten years.

I started as a data scientist in 2019 and was promoted to a senior position less than a year later.

Selected other experience

eResearch Analyst, Deakin University - Intersect Australia

2018-2019

Based at Deakin University, Burwood, reporting to the Director of the eResearch team, Dr Christopher McAvaney. My role was to service researcher at the the Burwood campus, including coordinating training, providing strategic support for faculties, and supporting researchers to incorporate computational techniques into their workflow.

► **Click** to see a selection of activities

eResearch Analyst, University of New England - Intersect Australia

2016-2018

Based at UNE, reporting to the Deputy Vice Chancellor - Research (DVCR), Prof. Heiko Daniel. Whilst located in the Research Services Directorate, to carry out this role effectively, I worked collaboratively with the University Library and the IT Directorate, as well as the faculties.

► **Click** to see a selection of activities

Research Fellow, Institute of Conflict Transformation and Social Justice, Queen's University (Belfast)

2014

Lead Monitoring & Evaluation Consultant, Women's Empowerment and Access to Justice project in Timor-Leste, Search for Common Ground (Washington)

2013

Education

Ph.D, *Cum laude*. University of New England, 2010-2015

M.Data Science. University of New England, 2018-*ongoing*

B.International Relations, *Distinction*. Deakin University, 2007-2009

Other training

Databricks training, 2025

Advanced R Shiny, 2022

R package development, 2020

Software Carpentry instructor accreditation, 2018

Technical Skills

My proficiency in selected ETL tools

R, Shiny app development, package development

Databricks and Apache Spark (PySpark and SparkR)

Python 2 and 3

SQL (SQLite, Oracle, Postgres and MySQL) and database design

Git, GitHub, CI/CD, GH Copilot, and version control standards

Bash, grep, sed

Javascript

Publications

[Read about them here...](#)

References

Provided on request.

paddytobias.github.io

paddytobias@me.com